

Response to Request for Information (RFI) on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

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Introduction

This response is submitted by Brian Charles, PhD, in response to the Federal Register notice [<https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/02/06/2025-02305/request-for-information-on-the-development-of-an-artificial-intelligence-ai-action-plan>].

I am an expert in the field of Artificial Intelligence and Organizational Leadership, with 30+ years of experience in strategic management and executive education to advance corporations' technology transformation goals. My insights are informed by years of research, teaching, and practical application of AI in various business contexts across the private and public sectors.

This response proposes to build a national repository of online microcourses that will benefit American industry and government by efficiently educating leaders in artificial intelligence (AI) so as to achieve strategic advantage on a global scale.

Background

For the past eight years, I have facilitated the Artificial Intelligence: Implications for Business Strategy program offered by MIT through 2U/edX [<https://executive.mit.edu/course/artificial-intelligence/a056g00000URaa3AAD.html>], educating thousands of executives on the responsible use of AI and its strategic application in businesses around the globe. Additionally, my forthcoming paper, "The Real Value of AI-Aided Executive Education" (Charles, B., Forthcoming, Academy of Management Learning and Education) explores the transformative potential of AI in enhancing learning experiences for executives (Charles, 2025).

My book, [Embracing the Future of Organizational Leadership: The Power of Artificial Intelligence](#) (Charles, 2024), further discusses how AI can be strategically integrated into organizational structures to foster innovation and efficiency. The body of my work

underscores the importance of fostering AI systems that are free from ideological bias or engineered social agendas, as echoed in recent federal directives (Executive Order, 2025).

Key Considerations for the AI Action Plan

In developing the Federal AI Action Plan, I urge consideration of the following microcourse components, with a particular emphasis on executive education aimed specifically at American business leaders and provided free of charge in order to promote American business competitiveness. These courses will be delivered in short-form format (i.e., “microcourses,” delivered via platforms such as X). For reference, a microcourse is defined as a short, focused interactive online course that can be completed at a user’s pace via a device or medium of their choice.

The following topics have been identified by this researcher as consistent with the Administration’s goals for the ‘AI Action Plan’ and the needs of business leaders studied by the researcher – and will be critical components to advancing US AI initiatives:

1. **Promoting AI Literacy and Skills Development:** A key component of the AI Action Plan should be to enhance AI literacy across all sectors, particularly within leadership roles. Executive education programs play a vital role in equipping leaders with the knowledge and skills necessary to understand and implement AI technologies effectively. This aligns with the imperative to promote American leadership in AI, as highlighted in the Executive Order (2025).
2. **Fostering Ethical AI Implementation:** Ethical considerations surrounding AI are paramount. The Action Plan should emphasize the importance of responsible AI development and deployment, including addressing issues such as data privacy, algorithmic bias, and transparency. Executive education can integrate ethical frameworks and case studies to guide leaders in making informed decisions about AI implementation (Charles, 2024). My research (Charles, 2025) emphasizes the need for careful consideration of the boundaries of AI use in executive education, ensuring a balance between technological innovation and human interaction.
3. **Encouraging Innovation through AI in Education:** The Action Plan should incentivize the integration of AI into educational methodologies. AI can personalize learning experiences, streamline communication, and foster critical thinking (Charles, 2025). Investment in AI-driven educational tools and platforms can significantly improve learning outcomes for executives and professionals.

4. **Addressing the Skills Gap:** As AI technologies continue to evolve, there is a growing need to address the skills gap in the workforce. The Action Plan should promote initiatives that encourage lifelong learning and skills development, enabling individuals to adapt to the changing demands of the AI-driven economy. Executive education programs can play a crucial role in upskilling and reskilling professionals to meet these demands. As noted in my paper, *The Real Value of AI-Aided Executive Education*, integrating AI into learning environments can significantly improve the application of learned skills in the workplace. (Charles, 2025)
5. **Public-Private Partnerships:** Encourage collaboration between government, academia, and industry to develop and deploy effective AI education and training programs – such as this proposal to build microcourses on X and/or other contemporary online platforms. These partnerships can leverage the expertise and resources of all stakeholders to address the challenges and opportunities presented by AI.
6. **Maintaining American Leadership in AI:** Aligning with the Executive Order (2025), the AI Action Plan should prioritize the development of AI systems that promote free markets, world-class research, and entrepreneurial spirit, while also addressing potential risks and biases. Executive education can play a critical role in fostering a culture of responsible AI innovation that upholds these values.
7. **Promulgating National Online Executive Education Courses:** As a concrete AI policy action, the US Government should consider developing and deploying national online executive education courses for all US business leaders – again, as-per this proposal. The objective is to improve their competitiveness by understanding how to implement AI responsibly and effectively in their workplaces. Recent data indicates that organizations that successfully integrate AI see a substantial increase in productivity and enhanced strategic decision-making [See: McKinsey Global Institute, "Notes from the AI frontier: Modeling the impact of AI on the world economy," September 2018]. This initiative would directly contribute to national growth and productivity.

A Proposed Microcourse Structure

I am confident that my extensive experience in teaching AI to executives, including my role on behalf of MIT for 2U/edX, positions me well to contribute to the development of such a

national program. Building upon the successful MIT course's general scope, a potential executive education program could be structured as follows:

- **Module 1: AI Fundamentals:** Introduction to AI concepts, machine learning, deep learning, and natural language processing.
- **Module 2: AI Strategy & Implementation:** Developing an AI strategy, identifying use cases, and implementing AI solutions in various business functions.
- **Module 3: Ethical AI & Governance:** Addressing ethical considerations, data privacy, algorithmic bias, and responsible AI governance.
- **Module 4: AI for Competitive Advantage:** Using AI to drive innovation, improve operational efficiency, and gain a competitive edge in the marketplace.
- **Module 5: AI Leadership & Change Management:** Leading AI initiatives, managing change, and fostering a culture of AI innovation within organizations.

The Role of AI in Enhancing Executive Education

AI can significantly enhance executive education by:

- **Personalized Learning:** Tailoring educational content to individual learner needs and **preferences** through AI-powered adaptive learning platforms.
- **Improved Engagement:** Utilizing AI-driven tools to create interactive and engaging learning experiences, such as simulations, virtual reality environments, and gamified modules. My research indicates that interactive learning significantly boosts retention rates among participants (Charles, 2025).
- **Data-Driven Insights:** Leveraging AI analytics to track learner progress, identify areas for improvement, and provide personalized feedback.
- **Enhanced Accessibility:** Making education more accessible to a wider audience through AI-powered translation tools, captioning services, and adaptive interfaces.

Conclusion

The development of a comprehensive Federal AI Action Plan presents a unique opportunity to harness the transformative potential of AI for the benefit of society. By prioritizing AI

literacy, ethical implementation, innovation, and skills development, we can ensure that the United States remains a leader in the AI era. Executive education, in particular, will be crucial in equipping leaders with the knowledge and skills necessary to navigate the complexities of AI and drive innovation within their organizations. Delivering such education in a format that is easy-to-consume and pervasive is both the challenge and the opportunity confronting the US in order for it to remain globally competitive in the age of AI.

It is imperative that we foster an environment where AI systems are developed and deployed responsibly, adhering to ethical principles and promoting American values (Executive Order, 2025). The implementation of national online executive education courses, as proposed, would represent a significant step toward realizing these goals.

Thank you for considering my input. I am available to provide further insights and expertise as needed.

References

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MIT Executive Education. (n.d.). Artificial Intelligence: Implications for Business Strategy. Retrieved from [<https://executive.mit.edu/course/artificial-intelligence/a056g00000URaa3AAD.html>]